



Thomas M. Siebel

Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer

\$389M (FY2025)

Revenue

Redwood City

HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

Thomas M. Siebel — Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, C3.ai.

In role: Founded C3 AI in 2009; resumed the CEO role on 8 May 2026 after stepping back during 2025, and continues as Chairman

Today: Leads C3 AI through a restructuring aimed at cutting cost and cash burn, with a stated shift from growth at any price toward profitable growth.

One of enterprise software's genuinely consequential founders. He built Siebel Systems into the dominant CRM company before its 2006 sale to Oracle, then founded C3 AI in 2009 and took it public in 2020. He is the author of four books, most recently *Digital Transformation: Survive and Thrive in an Era of Mass Extinction* (2019), and sits on the College of Engineering boards at the University of Illinois and UC Berkeley. He stepped back from the CEO role during 2025 and resumed it in May 2026; the company set out the circumstances in its own results announcement.

Career: Chairman & Chief Executive Officer (resumed), C3 AI; Chairman (stepped back from CEO), C3 AI; Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, C3 AI; Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Siebel Systems (sold to Oracle, 2006)

Education: BA History, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign; MBA, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign; MSc Computer Science, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign;

The company: Public but smaller and less differentiated than Palantir, with real recent strain: revenue growth has decelerated sharply, founder Tom Siebel resumed the CEO role in May 2026 after a health-related leadership change, and Glassdoor sentiment has fallen from 3.1 to 2.9 over the past year.

What they sell: C3 Agentic AI Platform (end-to-end build/deploy/operate environment) plus 40+ prebuilt, industry-specific Enterprise AI applications and C3 Generative AI tools.

02 Where The Company Sits

Closest comparable to Sand on "vertical AI applications" positioning, but sells software licenses/subscriptions rather than the services-heavy delivery model Sand uses — and is currently the most stressed name on this list financially and organizationally.

03 Talking Points

- A founder who has built and sold a category-defining enterprise software company before — he will engage on the business model, not the demo.
- Leadership continuity is a live question here in a way it is not at other vendors. Worth understanding the succession plan before committing a PortCo to a multi-year platform.
- The company is restructuring toward profitability, which means commercial flexibility may be greater now than it was a year ago.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Customer concentration risk: Baker Hughes has historically been ~20–30% of revenue via a JV with renegotiated minimums
- Quarterly revenue has decelerated markedly (Q3 FY2025 from \$98.8M in Q3 FY2025 to \$51.6M in Q4 FY2026, per filings)
- Founder Tom Siebel stepped back for health reasons in Sept 2025, then resumed the CEO role in May 2026 — real leadership turbulence

04 GIP Context

GIP: No connection found. None of C3.ai's named customers (Shell, Baker Hughes, Bank of America, U.S. Air Force/Army, Cargill, Koch) are GIP portfolio companies.

BlackRock: Confirmed passive ownership — 6.8% of shares outstanding per BlackRock's April 2026 Schedule 13G/A filing, its largest disclosed institutional holder after Vanguard (6.1%) and founder Thomas Siebel's combined family/trust stakes (~15%+).

Others at C3.ai: Stephen Ehikian (President); Edward Abbo (Chief Technology Officer)

[c3.ai](#) · [C3 AI leadership page](#) · [CEO resumption announcement](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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